



Strengthening the
ecosystem for
sustainable student
mobility

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Catalogue of green practices

University of Belgrade -
Faculty of Organizational Sciences



UNIVERSITY OF BELGRADE
FACULTY OF ORGANIZATIONAL SCIENCES

A sustainable guide for students traveling to Belgrade, Serbia

INTRODUCTION

The Catalogue of Green Practices in front of you has been developed as a practical guide to help you adopt more environmentally responsible lifestyles while in Belgrade, Serbia, home to the University of Belgrade - Faculty of Organizational Sciences (FON). The Catalogue brings together simple, practical, and informed ideas that can be applied in your everyday life, whether while you are in Belgrade or at FON studying. The Catalogue covers awareness and motivation, habits - such as living and accommodation, buying and consumption, digital habits, and community engagement.

The Faculty - FON is located at Jove Ilića 154 street in Belgrade, in a lively urban area surrounded by Banjicka forest, and connected by buses, trams, walking routes, and cycling routes. In Belgrade and at FON, you also have access to public libraries, local markets, green spaces, cultural venues, and a wide range of volunteering opportunities. As Belgrade is a large and diverse city, the most sustainable option may not be the same for everyone. The aim is therefore not to be perfect, but to choose smarter, lower-impact alternatives whenever they realistically suit your route, budget, safety, and available time.

Belgrade consists of 17 city municipalities, 10 urban and 7 suburban, and has approximately 1.7 million residents in its wider administrative area. Its size, diversity, and fast pace can make sustainable living challenging sometimes, but they also offer many opportunities for sustainable travel, responsible consumption, community action, and everyday environmental choices.

A particularly positive step towards more sustainable urban mobility is that, since 1 January 2025, regular public transport in Belgrade has been free of charge for residents and visitors. The measure covers city and suburban buses, trams, trolleybuses, and BG Voz trains, making lower-impact travel more accessible to students regardless of their budget. By choosing public transport instead of travelling alone by car whenever possible, students can reduce congestion and emissions while moving around the city more affordably and conveniently. Belgrade is currently the largest European city to have introduced a city-wide free public transport system.

In 2024, the city was named one of Serbia's winners in the Sustainable Urban Mobility category, while its Sustainable Urban Mobility Plan had previously been selected as a finalist for the European SUMP Award.

Belgrade is also developing local green initiatives that bring communities and nature closer together. In New Belgrade, the "Green New Belgrade" project includes activities such as "Growing Together" and "Tree of a Generation," implemented in cooperation with the public landscaping company Zelenilo-Beograd and local educational institutions. Through tree planting and community participation, these initiatives help expand urban greenery while encouraging young people to care for the environment around them.



AWARENESS/MOTIVATION

At FON, sustainability awareness and motivation are supported through both academic work and practical student activities.

Sustainability is integrated into teaching across all study levels. At the bachelor level, you can explore environmental and sustainability topics through courses such as Environmental Management, Eco-Marketing, Design for the Environment, and Environmental Quality Systems. At the master level, the offer expands to subjects including Integrated Environmental Management, Sustainable Development, Circular Economy - Principles and Concepts, Environmental Risk Management, Environmental Change Management and Resource Economics, Environmental Product Suitability and Energy Efficiency, Energy Efficiency Management Systems, Environmental Management Systems, and Models of Social Responsibility. At the doctoral level, you can further develop advanced knowledge through courses such as Environmental Management - Selected Topics, and Medical Waste Management. Together, these courses allow you to approach sustainability from managerial, technological, economic, and social perspectives and to connect academic learning with practical environmental challenges.

The Center for Environmental Management and Sustainable Development (Centar za ekološki menadžment i održivi razvoj - CEMOR) brings together teaching, research, projects, and outreach related to environmental management and sustainable development, while EkoFON, a student environmental organization from FON, provides a platform for student participation and green initiatives.



PLANT A TREE FOR THE FUTURE

Tree planting has become a valued annual tradition at FON, bringing together students, staff, partners, and guests, around a simple but meaningful environmental action. Each year, new trees are planted at the faculty grounds as part of activities dedicated to Earth Day and sustainable development. Beyond improving the surrounding space, the initiative raises awareness of the importance of biodiversity, urban greenery, and long-term care for the environment. It also gives the FON community an opportunity to turn sustainability from an academic topic into a visible, shared, and lasting contribution. The tree is then taken care of by the Faculty members and students all year long. You are also encouraged to take part in yearly tree-planting organized by CEMOR, environmental workshops, volunteering actions, and organized visits to events such as the Science Picnic, where sustainability topics are presented in an engaging and interactive way to the youngest population. These activities help students connect environmental knowledge with everyday choices, teamwork, creativity, and community action, showing that sustainability is not only something to study, but also something to experience and practice.

FON is also currently developing its first Sustainability Report, the first report of its kind at the University of Belgrade and one of the first faculty-level sustainability reports in Serbia. This initiative provides an important foundation for presenting green practices not only as individual tips and activities, but also as part of a broader system for monitoring sustainability performance, setting measurable goals, and strengthening institutional responsibility. By collecting and reporting relevant data, FON aims to better understand its environmental and social impacts, track progress over time, and support more informed and transparent sustainability decisions across the faculty community.



HABITS

Everyday habits shape a large part of our environmental impact. While studying at FON, your habits are closely connected to the rhythm of life in Belgrade, a busy, diverse city where commuting, studying, food, shopping, digital devices, and managing accommodation all involve daily choices. Some students live close to the faculty, while others travel from different parts of the city or surrounding municipalities, so the most sustainable option will not always look the same for everyone.

By choosing lower-impact transport, saving energy and water, reducing waste, consuming more thoughtfully, and using technology responsibly, you can gradually build habits that are better for both the environment and your own quality of life.

TRAVEL

Belgrade is a large and dynamic city, and you may travel to FON from very different neighborhoods, municipalities, or nearby towns. For this reason, there is no single “perfect” sustainable route for everyone. The best choice depends on distance, available connections, safety, accessibility, weather, budget, and time. The aim is to choose the lowest-impact option that is realistic for each journey - whether that means walking, cycling, using public transport, sharing a ride, combining several transport modes, or simply avoiding unnecessary solo car trips. If you live close to FON, try walking for short trips or combining walking with public transport, you will not be alone in this – the area around FON and the Banjicka forest are a popular destination for joggers and exercise. If you cycle, choose safer routes, use lights and a helmet, and check bike-friendly parts of the city in advance. Belgrade does not work the same as a small cycling city, so safety and realistic route planning matter.

USE PUBLIC TRANSPORT

Since 1 January 2025, regular public transport in Belgrade has been free of charge, making buses, trams, trolleybuses, and BG Voz an especially accessible option for students. Want to learn more about how your choices of transportation lower or raise carbon emissions? Check out this article from the United Nations.

Before leaving, check current routes, stops, timetables, and temporary service changes, especially because roadworks and major events can affect traffic. A good way to check live events and traffic is to follow Moj Beograd page on Instagram. When possible, avoid the busiest travel periods or allow extra time during morning and afternoon rush hours.

USEFUL TRANSPORT APPS AND WEBSITES

Planning ahead can make sustainable travel around Belgrade much easier. You can use [Beograd Plus](#) for information about Belgrade public transport, current service conditions, changes, and news. [Moovit](#), Google Maps, and [Yandex Maps](#) can help you compare routes and combine walking, buses, trams, trolleybuses, and BG Voz, although real-time information may occasionally differ between platforms.

For train travel, the official [Srbijavoz](#) app allows you to check timetables and buy one-way, return, and subscription tickets online. For intercity buses, [Polazak](#) is useful for comparing departures and timetables, while [BAS](#) provides information for services departing from Belgrade Bus Station. [FlixBus](#) may also be useful for selected regional and international routes.

For shared travel, [BlaBlaCar](#) helps passengers find drivers travelling in the same direction, making longer journeys more affordable and reducing the number of partly empty cars on the road. When cycling is practical, you can also check local bicycle-rental providers and Belgrade's seasonal Park and Cycle programme.

As part of the “[Park and Cycle](#)” initiative, Parking Servis Belgrade has provided bicycles for both children and adults. You can borrow bicycles while your vehicles are parked in the following Parking Servis garages and car parks:

- [Obilicev venac garage](#)
- [Zeleni venac garage](#)
- [Masarikova garage](#)
- [Ada Ciganlija Car park](#)
- Milan Gale Muskatirovic Car park

Bicycles can be borrowed temporarily every day from 9:00 a.m. to 9:00 p.m. by presenting a valid ID card. Bicycle use is free of charge; you only pay the standard parking fee for your vehicle.

Before travelling, compare at least two sources, especially for delays, temporary route changes, roadworks, and weekend or holiday timetables.

RENT A BIKE AT ADA CIGANLIJA

[Ada Ciganlija](#), a beautiful river island, where you can bathe in the summer, walk, have an ice cream or try roller blading, is one of the easiest places in Belgrade to try cycling in a safer and more relaxed environment. A bicycle route approximately 11.2 kilometers long runs around Lake Sava, and bicycles can be rented by [Rent a bike Ada](#) throughout the year at several locations around Ada, including the New Belgrade and Makiš sides. Rental points offer bicycles for different age groups, making this a good option for recreation, exercise, or simply exploring one of Belgrade's best-known green areas on two wheels. If you do not own a bicycle you can therefore test cycling without committing to buying one first.

LIVING AND ACCOMMODATION

Where and how you live can strongly influence your use of energy, water, and other resources. In Belgrade, as a student, you may stay in university dormitories, rented apartments, shared flats, or family homes, and you do not always have full control over heating systems, cooling, appliances, or waste infrastructure. Some accommodation costs may be included in the rent, while others are paid separately, which can also affect how visible everyday resource use feels. For this reason, sustainable living is not about expecting everyone to have the same options, but about making responsible choices wherever possible.

Belgrade's hot summers and cold winters can lead to high use of air conditioning and heating, while busy student schedules can make frequent laundry, long showers, food waste, and devices left on standby feel like minor issues. However, simple habits, such as keeping room temperatures moderate, washing full loads, taking shorter showers, turning off the tap, unplugging chargers, and separating waste where facilities are available can reduce environmental impact and often lower household expenses as well. Even when you cannot change the building or heating system, you can still improve the way you use your living space.

A sustainable student room does not need to be perfect or expensive. It can begin with a few realistic routines: switching off lights when leaving, airing rooms briefly rather than keeping windows open for long periods during heating season, using reusable household items, avoiding unnecessary purchases, and communicating with roommates about shared energy, water, and waste habits. In a large city like Belgrade, these small actions can become especially meaningful when thousands of students practice them together.

ELECTRICITY

EARTH HOUR IN BELGRADE

If you are walking around the city on this specific date, don't be surprised to see buildings and houses in the dark with their lights turned off! Every year, households, institutions, organizations, and public buildings in Belgrade take part in Earth Hour, a global WWF initiative that invites people to switch off non-essential lights for one hour. The action usually takes place in the evening and serves as a symbolic reminder that everyday energy use, climate change, and nature protection are closely connected. In Belgrade, participation has included residents switching off lights at home, public campaigns, and major buildings and landmarks dimming their lighting in support of the initiative. Although one hour alone cannot solve environmental problems, it can encourage people to think about energy-saving habits they can practice throughout the year.

QUICK TIPS FOR GREENER LIVING

- Wash full loads: running the washing machine less often saves both water and electricity.
- Choose lower washing temperatures: for lightly soiled clothes, cooler cycles usually use less energy than hot washes.
- Air-dry when possible: skipping the tumble dryer reduces electricity use and can help clothes last longer.
- Lower the heating by just 1°C: this can reduce energy use by around 7%.
- Keep summer cooling moderate: use blinds, shade, and fans before lowering the air-conditioning temperature.
- Take short showers: heating water requires energy, so shorter showers save both water and electricity.
- Turn off the tap: do not let water run while brushing your teeth or soaping.
- Switch off lights and devices: avoid leaving lights on in empty rooms and unplug chargers when they are not needed.
- Join Earth Hour: once a year, people around the world switch off non-essential lights for one hour as a symbolic action for the planet.
- Sort waste correctly: recycling works only when materials are placed in the appropriate bins and are not heavily contaminated.
- Share with roommates: agreeing on heating, laundry, lighting, and waste routines makes sustainable living much easier.

GREENER CLASSROOMS AT FON

FON is working towards introducing greener classroom practices that make sustainability part of everyday teaching and studying. These include switching off lights, projectors, computers, and air-conditioning when rooms are not in use; reducing unnecessary printing; using digital learning materials; separating waste; and encouraging students to bring reusable bottles and mugs. One simple digital option is to use Ecosia as a search engine: the company directs all its profits towards climate action, with most of the funding supporting tree-planting projects. By combining small classroom routines with wider initiatives such as green classrooms, responsible digital use, and student awareness campaigns, FON strives to make sustainability more visible, practical, and easy to practice every day.

RECYCLING

Recycling in Belgrade is gradually becoming more accessible through dedicated recycling containers, collection points, public campaigns, and community initiatives. Around the city, you can find separate containers and recycling points for materials such as paper, cardboard, PET plastic, metal packaging, and glass. JKP Gradska čistoća also provides an online map of recycling containers, which can help you find the nearest available collection point. Before recycling, packaging should be emptied and, where possible, lightly cleaned and flattened to save space. Different locations may accept different materials, so students should always check the labels on the container instead of assuming that every recyclable item belongs in the same bin. Waste that is heavily contaminated with food, oil, or other substances can make recycling more difficult.

WHAT CAN YOU RECYCLE?

Depending on the available containers and collection points, you can usually separate:

- paper and cardboard;
- plastic bottles and PET packaging;
- cans and other metal packaging;
- glass bottles and jars;
- selected electronic waste;
- bottle caps through humanitarian recycling initiatives.

You can use [Gde reciklirati](#) recycling map to search for locations in Belgrade and across Serbia. JKP Gradska čistoća also operates collection points where citizens can hand in selected recyclable materials. Some city-market locations accept PET packaging, metal packaging, and newspapers, while a wider range of secondary raw materials can be delivered to the waste facility [Reciklomat](#) in Višnjička Street.

BULKY AND ELECTRONIC WASTE

Furniture, large household items, and electronic devices should not be left beside regular waste containers. JKP Gradska čistoća traditionally provides free collection of bulky and electronic waste during the first weekend of each month. Residents can contact the City Service Centre or the local [Gradska čistoća](#) unit to arrange collection or obtain current instructions.

Old phones, laptops, chargers, batteries, and other electronic items should be taken to authorized e-waste collection points like [E Reciklaža](#) rather than placed in mixed household waste. These products may contain valuable materials, but also substances that require proper treatment.

TEXTILE REUSE AND RECYCLING

Clothing and other textiles that are no longer needed can be donated to [FabrIQa RS](#), which collects them for humanitarian purposes or further industrial use. Depending on their condition, the items may be reused, redistributed, or processed as secondary raw materials. Donating unwanted textiles helps extend their useful life, reduces waste, and supports a more circular approach to fashion and consumption.

BOTTLE CAPS THAT MAKE A DIFFERENCE

In Serbia, collecting plastic bottle caps is both an environmental and a humanitarian activity. Two well-known initiatives, Čep za hendikep and Čepom do osmeha, collect plastic caps and send them for recycling. The funds generated through recycling are then used to support people with disabilities and children with developmental difficulties by purchasing assistive devices and other necessary equipment.

The initiative Čep za hendikep was created by people with disabilities as a grassroots response to the difficulty of obtaining and replacing orthopedic and assistive devices, while Čepom do osmeha is a large volunteer-based environmental and humanitarian initiative that connects recycling, solidarity, and community participation. Through thousands of volunteers and collection boxes across Serbia, plastic caps are gathered, recycled, and transformed into practical support for children and families.

FON AND “ČEPOM DO OSMEHA”

FON has established a cooperation with Čepom do osmeha initiative and provides clearly marked collection bins for plastic bottle caps within the faculty. Students, staff, and visitors can place clean plastic caps in these containers throughout the year. The collected caps are donated annually, turning a very small everyday action into both an environmental contribution and meaningful social support.

This initiative shows that recycling is not only about separating waste. It can also build solidarity, encourage student participation, and connect environmental responsibility with care for the wider community.

QUICK RECYCLING TIPS

- Check the label before placing an item in a recycling container.
- Empty bottles, cans, and jars before recycling.
- Flatten cardboard boxes and plastic bottles to save space.
- Keep paper dry and free from food contamination.
- Separate bottle caps and place them in the dedicated FON collection bins.
- Never place batteries, electronics, chemicals, or medical waste in ordinary recycling bins.
- Use recycling maps to find the nearest collection point.
- When unsure, ask - incorrectly sorted waste can contaminate the whole recycling stream.

BUYING AND CONSUMPTION

GIVE CLOTHES A SECOND LIFE

These places can be great for finding affordable, unusual, and high-quality clothes while reducing textile waste and extending the life of existing garments.

Try to:

- visit vintage and second-hand stores before buying new;
- explore flea markets for clothes, shoes, bags, and accessories;
- swap items with friends or organise a student clothing exchange;
- rent formalwear, costumes, or special-occasion outfits;
- repair zips, seams, buttons, and damaged fabric;
- alter clothing that no longer fits;
- donate or resell items you no longer wear;
- support local designers and small producers;
- ask yourself whether you will wear an item at least 30 times before buying it.

A small repair or creative alteration can turn an almost-forgotten item into a favourite again. Sustainable fashion is not about having less style - it is about making more thoughtful use of what already exists.

Belgrade offers plenty of ways to enjoy fashion without always buying new. You can explore curated vintage and second-hand stores such as [Jane Doe Vintage & Design Shop](#), [Šmizla Vintage](#), [Vintage Beograd](#), [RETRO Second Hand](#), as well as many smaller thrift shops across Dorćol, Vračar, Zvezdara, Voždovac, and New Belgrade. Flea markets and buvljaci - including markets in Zemun, Kalenić, and Bujanj Potok, can be good places to search for affordable clothes, accessories, bags, shoes, books, and unique retro pieces, although opening days and the selection can vary.

Belgrade also has numerous tailors and alteration shops where clothing can be shortened, resized, repaired, or redesigned, helping favourite garments stay in use for longer. Formal dresses, suits, costumes, and special-occasion clothing can also be rented from local fashion studios and rental services such as [Rent a Porter](#) instead of being purchased for a single event. Swapping clothes with friends, donating items, buying from local designers, choosing durable pieces, and repairing before replacing are all practical ways to make fashion in Belgrade more circular, creative, and budget-friendly.

SUSTAINABLE FOOD CHOICES IN BELGRADE

Food is an important part of our environmental footprint, but sustainable eating does not have to be expensive, complicated, or based on a perfect diet. For students in Belgrade, it can begin with practical choices: eating more plant-based meals, reducing food waste, choosing seasonal produce, carrying reusable containers, and buying only as much food as can realistically be eaten. Traditional Serbian meals based on beans, lentils, peas, potatoes, cabbage, peppers, grains, soups, and seasonal salads can also provide affordable and satisfying alternatives to meals centred on meat.

EAT SMARTER AROUND FON

As students at FON you can make more sustainable food choices even during busy study days. Before buying food, check whether you already have a meal, snack, or leftovers that can be brought from home in a reusable container. Carrying a reusable water bottle, travel mug, and cutlery can help reduce single-use packaging, especially when buying coffee or takeaway food.

When eating near the Faculty, look for meals that include vegetables, beans, lentils, grains, soups, or salads, and consider choosing a meat-free option from time to time. If portions are large, share a meal or save what remains for later when it can be stored safely. The most sustainable meal is often not a special “eco” product, but one that is nutritious, affordable, eaten completely, and served with as little unnecessary packaging as possible.

VISIT A LOCAL PIJACA

Belgrade’s open-air food markets, known locally as pijace, are an important part of the city’s food culture. They give students an opportunity to buy fresh fruit, vegetables, herbs, eggs, dairy products, preserves, and other foods, often directly from small producers or specialised vendors. Markets can make it easier to notice what is currently in season and to buy only the quantity needed.

The Voždovac Market, located at Jove Ilića 72, is particularly convenient for the FON community because it is on the same street as the Faculty. Students can also explore the Banjica and Dušanovac markets in the wider Voždovac area.

When shopping at a market:

- Bring a reusable tote bag and smaller produce bags.
- Choose seasonal fruit and vegetables.
- Ask vendors where the products come from.
- Select “imperfect” produce if it is still fresh and edible.
- Buy realistic quantities to avoid food waste.
- Compare prices before purchasing.
- Avoid taking a new plastic bag for every item.
- Plan meals around what is fresh and available.

Buying at a pijaca does not automatically guarantee that every product is local or sustainably produced, so it is always worth asking the seller about its origin.

WELL-KNOWN BELGRADE MARKETS

Find a pijaca near you. Some of Belgrade's best-known green markets include:

- Kalenić Market - Vračar
- Zeleni Venac Market - Savski venac
- Skadarlija Market, commonly known as Bajloni Market - Stari grad
- Đeram Market - Zvezdara
- Palilula Market - Palilula
- Zemun Market - Zemun
- Block 44 Market - New Belgrade
- Banovo Brdo Market - Čukarica
- Banjica Market - Voždovac
- Voždovac Market - Jove Ilića
- Dušanovac Market - Voždovac
- Vidikovac Market - Rakovica
- Senjak Market - Savski venac
- Karaburma Market - Palilula
- Mirijevo Market - Zvezdara
- Konjarnik Market - Zvezdara
- Zvezdara Market - Bulevar kralja Aleksandra
- Bežanija Market - New Belgrade
- Borča Market - Palilula
- Gornja Varoš Market - Zemun

For a complete list of markets and their addresses check this [link](#) out.

CHOOSE SEASONAL FOOD

Seasonal produce is often fresher, more affordable, and less dependent on long storage periods. In Belgrade, this might mean strawberries, cherries, peas, and leafy vegetables in spring; tomatoes, peppers, cucumbers, watermelons in summer, pumpkins, apples, grapes, cabbage, and root vegetables in autumn, and stored apples, potatoes, beans, cabbage, carrots, and preserved foods during winter.

Instead of searching for the same fruit and vegetables throughout the year, let the season help plan your meals. A market visit can become a simple way to see what is naturally abundant and usually better priced at that moment.

REDUCE THE IMPACT OF YOUR DIET

Students do not need to become vegetarian or vegan overnight to make a difference. Try beginning with one or two plant-based meals per week, reducing the frequency of beef and other resource-intensive foods, and increasing the use of beans, lentils, chickpeas, mushrooms, grains, and seasonal vegetables.

Simple student-friendly ideas include:

- prebranac or bean stew,
- lentil or vegetable soup,
- vegetable risotto,
- pasta with seasonal vegetables,
- baked potatoes and salad,
- hummus and fresh vegetables,
- oatmeal with seasonal fruit,
- vegetable sandwiches or wraps.

The aim is not dietary perfection, but greater variety and a gradual shift towards meals with a lower environmental impact.

PLAN MEALS AND USE LEFTOVERS

Food that is purchased but never eaten wastes all the water, energy, land, labour, transport, and money used to produce it. Before shopping, check the fridge and cupboards, prepare a short list, and plan a few flexible meals rather than buying food without a plan.

Try to:

- store food correctly;
- place older products where they can be seen;
- freeze suitable leftovers;
- use ripe fruit in smoothies, oatmeal, or baking;
- turn cooked vegetables into soups or sauces;
- use stale bread for toast, croutons, or breadcrumbs;
- understand the difference between “best before” and “use by” dates;
- serve smaller portions first and take more if needed.

CHOOSE TAKEAWAY MORE CAREFULLY

Takeaway food can create significant amounts of single-use packaging. When ordering, decline unnecessary cutlery, napkins, straws, and condiment sachets. Choose collection rather than delivery when the restaurant is within walking distance, combine orders with friends, and select restaurants that use returnable, recyclable, or minimal packaging. When possible, eat at the restaurant or bring an accepted reusable container. However, food safety and the restaurant’s hygiene rules should always come first.

QUICK FOOD CHALLENGE

This week, try to:

- prepare one meal from food you already have,
- eat one plant-based meal,
- visit a local pijaca,
- carry your reusable bottle and bag,
- rescue one ingredient before it goes to waste,
- avoid unnecessary takeaway packaging.

CHOOSE LOCAL – “KUPUJMO DOMAĆE”

The idea behind “Kupujmo domaće” or “Buy Local”, is to encourage consumers to choose products made in Serbia whenever this is practical and affordable. Buying domestic food can support local farmers, small producers, family businesses, and jobs within the national economy, while shorter supply chains may also reduce the need for long-distance transport and storage. You can support this approach by checking product labels, asking vendors at local markets where food comes from, and choosing seasonal Serbian products instead of imported alternatives when suitable options are available. Buying local is not automatically sustainable in every case, but it can be a positive step when combined with seasonal choices, minimal packaging, responsible production, and reduced food waste.

DIGITAL HABITS

Digital technology is an essential part of student life, but phones, laptops, tablets, chargers, headphones, and other electronic devices also have an environmental footprint. Their production requires energy and valuable raw materials, while devices that are replaced too quickly become electronic waste. More sustainable digital habits therefore begin with using equipment for longer, protecting it from damage, repairing it when possible, and avoiding unnecessary upgrades.

You can make their digital routines greener by:

- activating energy-saving and battery-saving modes,
- reducing screen brightness when appropriate,
- switching off devices instead of leaving them permanently on standby,
- unplugging chargers when they are not in use,
- maintaining and updating devices so that they remain useful for longer,
- repairing screens, batteries, and other components before replacing the whole device,
- donating or selling functional equipment that is no longer needed,
- deleting unnecessary files and duplicate photos,
- unsubscribing from unwanted newsletters,
- using links instead of sending multiple large attachments,
- printing only when genuinely necessary.

RECYCLE OLD DEVICES RESPONSIBLY

Old phones, laptops, tablets, routers, chargers, batteries, and other electronic equipment should never be placed in ordinary household waste or standard recycling bins. Electronic devices may contain both valuable recoverable materials and hazardous components that require professional treatment.

In Belgrade, students can return selected old devices through authorised recycling operators and telecommunications providers. Yettel stores across Serbia accept old phones, and the company's expanded recycling programme also covers devices such as tablets, laptops, smartwatches, routers, chargers, headphones, and Bluetooth speakers.

Specialised operators such as E-Reciklaža also organise the collection and treatment of electrical and electronic waste, including free collection arrangements under the conditions stated by the operator.

Before giving away or recycling a phone, tablet, or computer:

- back up the files you want to keep,
- sign out of personal accounts,
- remove SIM and memory cards,
- perform a factory reset,
- delete saved passwords and payment information,
- check whether the device can first be repaired, donated, or reused,
- take damaged or swollen batteries only to an authorised collection point.

If a device still works, extending its life through reuse or donation is usually preferable to immediately treating it as waste.

DIGITAL RESPONSIBILITY AT FON

At FON, digital sustainability has become part of everyday teaching, administration, and student life. Students and staff use electronic learning materials, submit assignments digitally, share links instead of printing documents, and switch off computers, projectors, screens, and chargers when classrooms are not in use. Equipment is maintained and repaired whenever practical, while devices that have reached the end of their useful life are transferred to authorised electronic-waste operators.

ENGAGEMENT IN THE COMMUNITY

Sustainability is not only about personal habits -it is also about caring for people and places around us. In Belgrade, you can take part in humanitarian campaigns, volunteering activities, donation drives, environmental clean-ups, support for vulnerable groups, and community events. Opportunities are available through organisations such as the [Red Cross](#), [ADRA Serbia](#), humanitarian foundations, local associations, student organisations, and neighbourhood initiatives. If you want to join a volunteer group, you can check out these websites as well - [Smart Kolektiv](#) and [Volonteri na mreži](#) by UNICEF. You can contribute by volunteering your time, collecting food, clothes, school supplies, hygiene products, or bottle caps, helping organise fundraising events, sharing verified appeals, or offering your professional and creative skills.

At FON, community engagement is encouraged through student-led humanitarian actions, charity bazaars, donation campaigns, volunteering days, environmental activities, and cooperation with trusted organisations. The Faculty community collects money and various items throughout the year and invites students to take part in local clean-ups or assistance programmes. Existing activities such as annual tree planting, cooperation with Čepom do osmeha, environmental workshops, and visits to public science and sustainability events show how learning, solidarity, and practical action can be connected.

You do not need large amounts of money or free time to help. Even one donated item, one hour of volunteering, one shared verified appeal, or one useful skill can support a wider community effort. The most important step is to choose a trustworthy organisation, check what is genuinely needed, and contribute in a respectful and responsible way.

WAYS TO GET INVOLVED

- Volunteer with the Red Cross or another recognised humanitarian organisation.
- Join food, clothing, book, toy, or hygiene-product collection drives.
- Donate blood when eligible and medically able.
- Support verified fundraising campaigns for medical treatment and social assistance.
- Help older adults or people with disabilities in the local community.
- Join environmental clean-ups, tree planting, and neighbourhood actions.
- Offer useful skills such as communication, design, IT support, translation, tutoring, or event organisation.
- Organise a student charity bazaar, quiz, sports event, or workshop.
- Share only verified appeals and official donation information.
- Invite friends and classmates - community action is easier and more effective when people work together.

Community engagement is already an important part of student life at FON. Student organizations organise humanitarian, environmental, educational, cultural, sporting, and professional activities throughout the academic year. FON organisations contribute through donation drives, student education, cultural activism, sports, peer learning, international cooperation, professional development, and events that connect students with the wider community. By joining these activities, you can contribute your time, ideas, organisational skills, creativity, or professional knowledge.

If you want to get involved with volunteering while studying at FON here are some ideas:

- The Union of Students of FON places particular emphasis on humanitarian work. Its annual external projects include a Humanitarian Sports Tournament and a Humanitarian Stand-Up Evening, alongside educational and entertainment projects.
- EkoFON promotes ecological awareness and sustainable development through environmental projects, training, volunteering, and cooperation with institutions, organizations, and companies active in environmental protection.
- AIESEC develops young people through projects, teamwork, international exchange, and professional networking, including its Open IT conference.
- BufoNERija contributes through cultural activism, arts education, peer learning, theatre, and events that create space for young people to express themselves and contribute to the wider community.
- SportFON promotes sport, teamwork, faculty representation, and cooperation among students and universities.

